

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dada DiCapo

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Dada DiCapo

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity

Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways.

- Former art-school collaborator of **Vincent Van Faux**; they remain close enough to annoy one another professionally.
- **Elle Loominate** has assisted on several of Dada's installations.
- **Drew Conclusions** has alternated between praising and savaging Dada in print.

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Dada DiCapo. If the room feels uncomfortable, good. I may invoice you for the feeling.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

INTRODUCTIONS

Dada DiCapo

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

Your other secret

You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

Conversations to start

- Enjoy watching people overreact to your warning note without admitting you wrote it.
- Find out whether Minnie Malist changed the lighting cue you designed.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

HUNT FOR CLUES

Dada DiCapo

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *Lift your eyes to a trophy, then look where it meets the shelf.*
- 2 *A secret waits behind drapes the colour of spilled wine.*
- 3 *Go where a thousand stories glow; this one waits behind the screen.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT I: MOTIVE

Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE

Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

Grant mistook a cheque for authorship. That closing spectacle was my unreleased performance concept. Grant took it, sanitized it and planned to unveil it with himself credited as creative patron. He bought the invitation stock, not my imagination. I wanted my work and my credit back.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:44 by the service-desk clock. I went there to study the shadow made by the external spotlight over the bowl. He had taken my performance; I was trying to reclaim one interesting angle. I preferred the warning note to remain an unsigned work. We argued about the performance credit in his salon.

IF MURDERER

My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:44 by the service-desk clock. I went there to adjust the little internal lamp to cast a better shadow behind the bowl. He had taken my performance; I was trying to reclaim one interesting angle. We argued about the performance credit in his salon.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACT III: METHOD

Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

ACT III: METHOD

Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

The unsigned warning is mine. “Return what was taken” meant my stolen performance concept. The star going dark was an image, not a timetable for a death. I wanted Grant publicly embarrassed. Apparently nobody is going to believe that distinction without a very long conversation.

Evidence Table / discovery index

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Gift agreement | 9. Education reallocation |
| 2. Shipping manifest / 1988 | 10. Donor Salon camera |
| 3. A warning left behind | 11. Donation entry / 1989 |
| 4. GRANT’S NIGHT OF GLORY | 12. Closing reveal / concept |
| 5. Treatment finding | 13. Display proposal / superseded |
| 6. Donor agreement / margin copy | 14. Clock inspection slip |
| 7. Auction result | 15. Cancelled programme cue |
| 8. Vincent Van Faux | 16. Grant Larceny’s toast |



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS

Dada DiCapo

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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COMING CLEAN

Dada DiCapo

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I wrote the warning note about my stolen performance. I changed the time of my inspection to cover that secret. The real job was to study the shadow made by the external spotlight over the bowl. I did it before the curtain closed, not at the late time I gave you. The work was real; my timetable was dishonest. I did not poison Grant Larceny.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

Grant mistook a cheque for authorship. That closing spectacle was my unreleased performance concept. Grant took it, sanitized it and planned to unveil it with himself credited as creative patron. He bought the invitation stock, not my imagination. I wanted my work and my credit back. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.